HACKATHON
UAE

BEYOND IDEAS · INTO IMPACT

TDRA · UAE HACKATHON 2026

Hackathon Training Agenda

Youth Track · HackArena 26 Oct – 28 Oct

Abu Dhabi

OVERVIEW · KEY DATES

Dates & Design Logic

BEYOND IDEAS · INTO IMPACT

26 Oct – 28 Oct · Abu Dhabi

OVERVIEW

The Three-Day Journey

DAY ONE
Understand & Explore

A clear problem, target user, solution concept, and initial plan for building.

DAY TWO
Build & Shape

A simple prototype teams can demonstrate and the foundations of the Business Model Canvas.

DAY THREE
Refine & Pitch

Final prototype and Business Model Canvas, a rehearsed story, and the final pitch.

CONTEXT & DESIGN LOGIC

Four Phases

P1
Understand the Problem

Teams understand who they are solving for, identify user needs and pain points, define the problem, and explore possible solutions. Design Thinking provides a simple structure for moving from user → problem → solution.

P2
Build and Shape the Solution

Teams move quickly from ideas into action. They create a simple prototype, receive mentor feedback, and iterate. The focus is not on producing a technically complete product, but on making the idea visible, understandable, and testable.

P3
Build the Business Model

Teams translate their solution into a Business Model Canvas, identifying their target users/customers, value proposition, channels, key activities, resources, partners, costs, and potential revenue streams.

P4
Communicate the Idea

Teams refine their prototype and business model into a concise story. The final day focuses heavily on pitch development, rehearsal, demonstration, Q&A, and final pitching.

DAY ONE

Understand & Explore

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8:30 – 16:00 · 11 sessions

Objective: Participants understand the challenge, identify the user need, explore possible solutions, and select one direction to develop. By the end of the day, each team has a clear problem, target user, solution concept, and initial plan for building.

COMMON all together GUIDED facilitator-led TEAM WORK teams work MENTORED mentors rotate

TIME	DURATION	SESSION	MODE	WHAT HAPPENS
08:30–09:00	30 min	**Registration**	COMMON	Registration of participants.
09:00–09:10	10 min	**Welcome Speech**	COMMON	Welcome participants, introduce the hackathon journey, expectations, three-day structure, outputs, and judging criteria.
09:10–09:30	20 min	**Keynote Speech**	COMMON	According to each location.
09:30–10:30	1 hr	**Session 1: Design Thinking: Understand & Define**	COMMON	Introduce users, stakeholders, needs, pain points, and problem framing. Participants learn how to move from a broad challenge toward a clear problem.
10:30–10:45	15 min	**Team Formation**	GUIDED	Guidelines for team formation. Formation of teams. Addressing challenges and guiding participants to join different teams. Facilitate matchmaking.
10:45–11:30	45 min	**Team Work 1 · Understand & Define** Mentor Round #1	TEAM WORK MENTORED	Teams identify their target users, explore their needs and pain points, review available information, and develop a clear problem statement. Mentors rotate between teams and challenge the problem definition: Who has the problem? Why does it matter? What evidence supports it?
11:30–12:30	1 hr	**Session 2: Design Thinking: Ideate**	GUIDED	Introduce practical ideation techniques. Teams learn how to generate multiple possible solutions before selecting one direction.
12:30–13:00	30 min	**Prayer Break**		
13:00-14:00	1 hr	**Team Work 2 · Ideate & Select** Mentor Round #2	TEAM WORK MENTORED	Teams generate solution options, compare them against the identified user need, and select one solution to develop. Mentors review the selected solution and help teams assess usefulness, clarity, feasibility, and differentiation.
14:00–15:00	1 hr	**Team Work 3 · Plan the Build**	TEAM WORK	Teams define the core idea they want to demonstrate, identify the minimum features needed for their prototype, assign team roles, and create a simple Day 2 task list.
15:00–15:15	15 min	**Wrap & Day 2 Preview**	GUIDED	Review progress and explain the build, and Business Model Canvas activities for Day 2.
15:15–16:00	45 min	**Lunch & Prayer**		

DAY TWO

Build & Shape

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9:00 – 16:00 · 8 sessions

Objective: Teams turn their selected idea into a simple prototype, work through short team work cycles, and develop the foundations of their Business Model Canvas. By the end of the day, teams have something they can demonstrate and a clear understanding of how their solution creates value.

COMMON all together GUIDED facilitator-led TEAM WORK teams work MENTORED mentors rotate

TIME	DURATION	SESSION	MODE	WHAT HAPPENS
09:00–09:15	15 min	**Daily Stand-Up**	COMMON	Teams briefly share what they are building, current status, their priorities, and any blockers.
09:15–10:30	1 hr 15 min	**Session 1: Design Thinking: Prototype & Test**	COMMON	Introduce prototyping as a way to make the idea visible and testable. Explore what makes a useful prototype, how to demonstrate an idea, how to test with users, and how to collect meaningful feedback.
10:30–11:30	1 hr	**Team Work 1 · Create & Test** Mentor Round #1	TEAM WORK MENTORED	Teams create their first prototype using accessible physical, digital and AI tools. The focus is on demonstrating the core idea rather than technical completeness. Mentors interact with the prototype as potential users/customers, identify what is clear or confusing, and provide practical feedback.
11:30–12:30	1 hr	**Session 2: Business Model Canvas – From Idea to Value**	COMMON	Introduce the BMC using simple examples. Focus on the relationship between the user, problem, value proposition, delivery, and sustainability.
12:30–13:00	30 min	**Prayer Break**		
13:00–14:00	1 hr	**Team Work 2 . Build the Business Model Canvas** Mentor Round #2	TEAM WORK MENTORED	Teams develop their BMC, focusing on customer/user segments, value proposition, channels, customer relationships, key activities, resources, partners, costs, and revenue. Mentors review whether the prototype and business model make sense together and help teams identify gaps.
14:00–15:00	1 hr	**Team Work 3 · Connect & Refine** Prepare final pitch	TEAM WORK	Teams refine the prototype and BMC together. They ensure that the problem, solution, target user, value proposition, and business model are aligned. Teams plan their pitch deck, demonstration, Business Model Canvas summary, and speaking roles.
15:00–15:15	15 min	**Wrap & Day 3 Preview**	GUIDED	Teams confirm what needs to be completed before pitching and identify their final priorities for Day 3.
15:15–16:00	45 min	**Lunch & Prayer**		

DAY THREE

Refine & Pitch

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9:00 – 16:00 · 5 sessions

Objective: Day 3 is intentionally pitch-heavy. Teams finalize their prototype and Business Model Canvas, develop their story, rehearse, receive feedback, and deliver their final pitch.

COMMON all together GROUP SPECIFIC session specific participation

TIME	DURATION	SESSION	MODE	WHAT HAPPENS
09:00–09:30	30 min	**Registration**	COMMON	Participant registration and attendance confirmation.
09:30-10:30	1 hr	**Team Pitch Rehearsals**	COMMON	Teams rehearse their final pitches, demonstrate their prototypes where applicable, present their business models, and respond to practice questions.
10:30-11:00	30 min	**Judges' Briefing**	GROUP SPECIFIC	Judges review the evaluation criteria, scoring procedures, and expectations for final presentations.
11:00-13:00	2 hrs	**Final Pitching & Judging 1**	COMMON	Teams present their solutions and business models, demonstrate prototypes where applicable, and respond to questions from the judges.
13:00-13:30	30 min	**Prayer Break**		
13:30-15:00	1 hr 30 min	**Final Pitching & Judging 2**	COMMON	Teams present their solutions and business models, demonstrate prototypes where applicable, and respond to questions from the judges.
15:00-15:15	15 min	**Closing**	COMMON	Closing remarks, recognition, and next steps.
15:15–16:00	45 min	**Lunch & Prayer**		